


*Illustration by*
SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

# STAKING LOST GROUND

The BJP may soon announce candidates for the 160 Lok Sabha seats where the party lost/won marginally in 2019. A Lok Sabha Pravas Yojana, under which Union ministers and veteran leaders will be deputed to these constituencies, is being organised to bolster the party's chances. Party general secretaries Sunil Bansal, Vinod Tawde and Tarun Chugh will be in charge of the mission. While the 160 seats are mostly concentrated in the east and south of the country, the party is also said to be worried about 50-odd seats in UP, Bihar and Maharashtra. Some of the key constituencies in the BJP's 'hit list' are held by top Opposition leaders such as Congress's **Sonia Gandhi** (Rae Bareli), SP's **Dimple Yadav** (Mainpuri) and **Supriya Sule** (Baramati) of the NCP (Sharad Pawar faction).

# STRONG HAND



The Congress party is looking to regain lost ground in the Lok Sabha seats where it takes on the BJP one-on-one in 2024, instead of negotiating a seat-sharing formula with its INDIA bloc allies. Most of these seats are in Rajasthan, Gujarat, MP, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka, Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh (128 LS seats altogether, of which Congress won just four in 2019). With reports suggesting a spike in **Rahul Gandhi**'s popularity after the Bharat Jodo Yatra, the party believes it can win back at least 50 seats. No wonder, Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot has declared Rahul the party's PM candidate.

# Playing Old Favourites

Gujarat Congress president **Shaktisinh Gohil** is alleging that the state government paid an excess Rs 3,802 crore to Adani Power Mundra Ltd—in lieu of the company importing coal from Indonesia at higher prices—without requisite documentation by the latter. Gohil is citing a letter from the electricity board Gujarat Urja Vikas Nigam Ltd as proof, but the state refutes this, claiming it was an 'interim' payout and that the issue is under a power purchase review.





# TITLE TATTLE

When the AIADMK cadre decided to call party supremo and former chief minister **Edappadi K. Palaniswami** (EPS) 'Puratchi Thamizhan (Revolutionary Tamil)' at the party's golden jubilee celebrations on August 20, it seemed like he was being raised to the same pedestal as the late J. Jayalalithaa ('Puratchi Thalaivi' or Revolutionary Leader). But then we already have a 'Puratchi Thamizhan' in badass actor Sathyaraj, a raucous villain of the '80s who turned hero and then character actor as he aged. Will EPS's fortunes follow a similar trajectory?

# Token Thaw

The frosty ties between Telangana governor **Tamilisai Soundararajan** and CM **K. Chandrashekar Rao** appeared to be thawing when he invited her to visit the new state secretariat on August 25 for the inauguration of a temple, mosque and church (built there at a public expense of Rs 10 crore). But a day after the event, the governor was at it again, asserting that per Article 167, the CM should meet her to sort out any issues and that criticising her post was unacceptable. A case of the pot calling the kettle black?



ANI

**Kaushik Deka with Jumana Shah and Amarnath K. Menon**